Installation and Setup Manual

Acme Automation Python + Selenium environment | Version 1.3 | Updated: 20 October 2026

1. System requirements

Windows 10 or 11 (64-bit), at least 8 GB RAM, 2 GB free disk space, internet access for package installation, Python 3.11 or 3.12, and Google Chrome.

2. Create the project

Create a folder named **C:\\Development\\AcmeAutomation**. Open that folder in VS Code. Open the integrated terminal and create a virtual environment using **python -m venv .venv**.

3. Activate the environment

For Windows PowerShell, run **.\\.venv\\Scripts\\Activate.ps1**. For Windows Command Prompt, run **.venv\\Scripts\\activate.bat**. If PowerShell blocks activation, use the Command Prompt terminal or follow the organization's approved execution-policy procedure.

4. Install dependencies

With the environment active, run **python -m pip install --upgrade pip**, then **python -m pip install selenium requests python-dotenv**. Save the installed versions with **python -m pip freeze > requirements.txt**.

5. Configure VS Code

Select the interpreter located at **.venv\\Scripts\\python.exe**. Create a file named main.py. Run it from the activated terminal with **python main.py**.

6. Verify setup

• Run python --version and confirm Python 3.11 or 3.12.

• Run python -m pip show selenium and confirm Selenium is installed.

• Run python -c "from selenium import webdriver; print('Selenium import successful')".

• Run a small browser test and confirm Chrome opens and closes.

7. Environment variables

Create a local .env file for ACME_API_TOKEN. Add .env and .venv/ to .gitignore. Do not share the .env file or commit it to GitHub.

8. Recreating the environment

If the environment is damaged, delete only the .venv folder and recreate it. Then activate the new environment and run **python -m pip install -r requirements.txt**. Your source files are separate from the virtual environment and should remain untouched.